

Motion Verbs Without Fact of Motion

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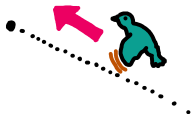
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Elements of a Motion Description

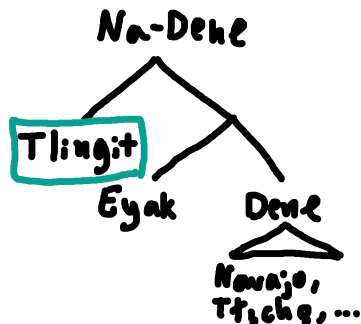


From (Talmy, 1975) cited in (Talmy, 2000):

- **Figure**, thing that's moving
- Path, where in space it moves (with respect to Ground)
- **Manner**, how it moves
- **Fact of Motion**, the fact that it's moving at all

Claim by Talmy (2000): "The 'fact-of-Motion' component of a Motion event always appears in the verb root."

Tlingit (*Lingít* [łín'kít])



- About 100 fluent speakers as of 2018. (Twitchell, 2018)
- Numerous revitalization programs, including language nest, school and university classes, adult classes. (Burge, 2024)

Tlingit Verb Structure

(1) gaxtoodats'éit'
PROSP.1PL.S.APSV.skin

“We’re going to skin.”

(Eggleston, 2017)

- Monosyllabic root.
- Derivational morphology can add idiomatic meaning and change argument structure.
- Subject and object pronouns and agreement interleaved with derivational morphology.
- Aspectual morphology interleaved with derivational morphology.
- Morpheme order may not reflect semantic scope (Crippen, 2019).

Tlingit Perfective and Imperfective

- (2) Loon awliyéx. Laax tsu awliyéx.
bark 3>3.PFV.make red.cedar also 3>3.PFV.make
“He carved bark. He carved red cedar.”
(Dauenhauer & Dauenhauer, 1987)
- (3) Woosh gunayáade át; daa sá yan wulihásh áwé
RECIP different thing; what Q ground PFV.drift FOC
alyéix.
3>3.IPFV.make
“Different kinds of material; whatever had drifted ashore is
what he carved.” (Dauenhauer & Dauenhauer, 1987)

yaa nat'éin
“It’s getting hot.”

- **Proclitic** *yaa*, *kei*, or *yei* depending on conjugation class.
 - For spatial verbs, *yaa* is “along”, *kei* is “up”, and *yei* is “down”.
- **N-conjugation prefix** (no matter what conjugation class).
- For CV roots, **-n suffix** and root vowel change.

Progressive can be either perfective or imperfective, but is usually imperfective.

Anatomy of a Tlingit Motion Description

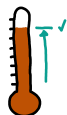
- (4) Aadé yaa ndakín.
it.toward along NCNJ.MID.fly.SG
“He/she/it is flying there.” (Eggleston, 2017)

- “Motion” root which often restricts figure and/or manner
- Progressive aspect
- Optional PP with explicit path

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Tlingit Aspectual Classes

Degree Achievement



- (5) Uwat'áa.
PFV.hot
"It's [gotten] hot."

State



- (7) Litseen.
STV.strong
"S/he is strong."

Motion



- (6) Du jeet aawa.áx.
3SG.H hand.to 3>3.PFV.hide.be.placed
"S/he gave it to him/her [hide/fabric]."

Activity



- (8) Axá.
3>3.eat
"S/he is eating it."

(Eggleston, 2017)

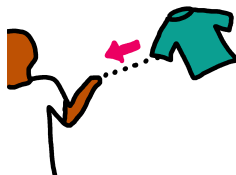
Progressive Degree Achievements



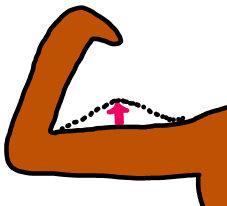
- (9) Yaa nat'éin.
along NCNJ.hot
“It’s getting hot.”

(Eggleston, 2017)

Progressive Motion Descriptions



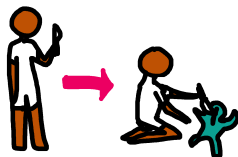
- (10) Du jeedé yaa ana.áx.
3SG.H hand.toward along 3>3.NC.NJ.hide.be.placed
“S/he’s giving it to him/her [hide/fabric].”
(Eggleston, 2017)



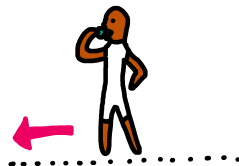
- (11) Kei naltseen.
up NCNJ.strong
“S/he is becoming strong.”

(Eggleston, 2017)

Progressive Activities



- (12) **Yaa** anatséit'.
along 3>3.NCNJ.skin
“S/he is starting to skin it.”



- (13) **Yaa** ana_xéin.
along 3>3.NCNJ.eat
“S/he is going along eating it.”
(Eggleston, 2017)

Summary of Effect of Progressive

Degree Achievement



Increasing degree

Motion Description



Advancing on path

State



Transition into state

Activity



Transition *or* motion

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Imperfective “motion” verbs describe position

Progressive



- (14) Du jeedé yaa ana.áx.
3SG.H hand.toward along 3>3.NCNJ.hide.be.placed
“S/he’s giving it to him/her [hide/fabric].”

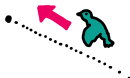
Plain Imperfective



- (15) Át .áx.
it.at hide.be.placed
“It’s sitting there [hide/fabric].”

Imperfective “motion” verbs are position (when they exist)

Progressive



- (16) Aadé yaa ndakín.
it.toward along NCNJ.MID.fly.SG
“He/she/it is flying there.”

Plain Imperfective

(does not exist)

(Eggleston, 2017)

Imperfective stative “motion” verbs

Progressive



- (17) Aadé yaa anal.át.
it.toward along 3>3.NCNJ.be.placed.PL

“S/he is carrying them there.”

(Eggleston, 2017)

Stative Imperfective



- (18) Áx nali.átk.
it.at NCNJ.STV.be.placed.PL.REP

“They (distributed) lie here and there along it.”

(Crippen, 2019)

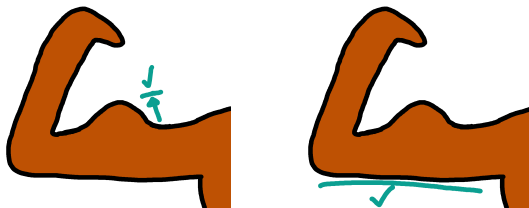
Anatomy of a Tlingit Motion Description Revisited

- (19) Aadé *yaa* *nda*kín.
it.toward *along* *NCNJ*.MID.*fly*.SG
“He/she/it is flying there.” (Eggleston, 2017)

- “*Motion*” *root* expresses that a figure is located in space and perhaps describes a manner (like flying).
- Optional PP with explicit path provides a scale on which transition is possible.
- *Progressive* aspect presupposes that a scale exists and expresses ongoing transition along that scale
 - If no PP or scale, adds a default spatial scale or event-onset scale.

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Perfective aspect is usually ambiguous between transition and result

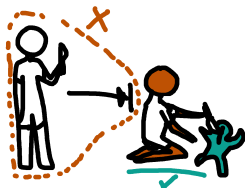


(20) Wulitseen.

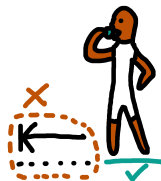
PFV.strong

“S/he became strong.” / “S/he was strong.”

Perfective aspect of activities must describe complete activity



- (21) Aawats'éit'.
3>3.PFV.skin
"S/he skinned it."



- (22) Aawa_xáa.
3>3.PFV.eat
"S/he ate it."
(Eggleston, 2017)

Perfective aspect of motion verbs can describe transition



- (23) Du jeeṭ aawa.áx.
3SG.H hand.to 3>3.PFV.hide.be.placed
“S/he gave it to him/her [hide/fabric].” (Eggleston, 2017)

Anatomy of a Tlingit Motion Description, Perfective

(24) Aadé wdikeen.
it.toward PFV.MID.fly.SG
“He/she/it flew toward there.” (Eggleston, 2017)

- “Motion” root expresses that a figure is located in space and perhaps describes a manner (like flying).
- Optional PP with explicit path provides a scale on which transition is possible.
- Perfective aspect, *when the verb phrase contains a scale*, can express transition along that scale.
 - Does not have a default scale if none exists in the VP.

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Summary

- Describing ongoing motion in Tlingit requires progressive aspect.
- Progressive aspect can add motion semantics to verbs that otherwise never have it.
- A “motion” verb without progressive aspect still encodes a spatial relationship and restricts the figure, but does not entail motion.
- Perfective aspect also adds motion semantics, but doesn't add scales if none exist.
- Therefore, the fact of motion is expressed by the aspect, not the verb root.

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Fonds de recherche – Nature et technologies
Fonds de recherche – Santé
Fonds de recherche – Société et culture

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